

# APPEALS AND CONDUCT COMMITTEE GUIDELINES

Our Appeals and Conduct Committee Guidelines outline the principles, structures, and procedures for handling academic appeals and conduct-related matters. These guidelines ensure learners are treated fairly, with respect and dignity, while upholding institutional integrity and community values. They provide a transparent framework for addressing grievances, misconduct, and disciplinary processes, in line with our Learner Code of Conduct and related governance documents.

## POLICY REVIEW NOTICE

This Policy is reviewed periodically and may be updated from time to time. Any changes will be published on our website and will become effective upon posting. Where changes are material, we may also provide additional notice, such as by email or through a prominent notice on the website.

This policy sets out the principles, structures, and procedures governing academic appeals and conduct-related matters within the institution. The goal is to ensure that Learners are treated with fairness, respect, and dignity, and that institutional integrity is maintained. The policy aligns with the commitments outlined in the Learner Handbook, Application and Selection Policy, and other related governance documents.

## 1. Who we Are

We act as a ‘controller’ of the personal data to all information collected through our website (<https://africainetwork.com>), “Website”, “African AI Network (AAN)” or collected for the Services, as identified below.

## 2. Purpose

**2.1.** To establish a transparent, just, and accessible framework for addressing Learner appeals and conduct concerns. The procedures aim to:

- **2.1.1.** Promote accountability, procedural fairness, and Learner protection.
- **2.1.2.** Provide clear mechanisms for addressing grievances and misconduct.
- **2.1.3.** Uphold institutional standards and community values.

## 3. Scope

**3.1.** This Policy applies to all active learners (the “Learners”) enrolled in one or more **AAN** programmes, regardless of the nature of the programme, learning modality (including in-person, online, or hybrid formats), or geographic location. It addresses:

- **3.1.1. Academic Appeals:** Decisions relating to grades, progression, assessment integrity, exclusions, and academic withdrawals.
- **3.1.2. Conduct Matters:** Incidents involving alleged misconduct including but not limited to harassment, discrimination, academic dishonesty, and violations of institutional codes of behaviour.

## 4. Definitions

**Active Learner:** Any individual that meets all the following conditions:

- **Subscription Status:** Has an ongoing, valid subscription plan that has not been canceled or terminated.
- **Access Rights:** Actively holds access to the platform's services, content, or features.
- **Payment Compliance:** Has successfully made the required payment for the current billing period.
- **Engagement:** Has been actively engaged on the platform within the last 12 months.

**Appeal:** A formal request by an Active Learner to the Committee asking for a review of an **AAN** decision concerning their academic performance or conduct.

**Committee:** Refers to either the **Appeals Committee** (academic/administrative challenges) or the **Conduct Committee** (code of conduct violations), established to investigate, deliberate, and make final determinations.

**Misconduct:** Any act or omission that breaches any **AAN** policy, code of conduct, or applicable law, whether committed on or off our learning platforms or at our **AAN Hubs**.

**Sanction:** A disciplinary measure imposed following a violation, ranging from warnings and probation to expulsion or revocation of certification.

## 5. Guiding Principles

**5.1.** The process is grounded in:

- **5.1.1. Fairness:** Right to a transparent process and opportunity to present a case.
- **5.1.2. Impartiality:** Review by unbiased individuals independent from the original decision.
- **5.1.3. Confidentiality:** Handled in accordance with data protection laws.
- **5.1.4. Accessibility:** Communicated in plain language with accommodations for disabilities.
- **5.1.5. Timeliness:** Completed in accordance with stated timelines.

- **5.1.6. Non-Retaliation:** Protection for those lodging or supporting appeals in good faith.
- **5.1.7. Right to Appeal:** Right to contest decisions materially affecting status or standing.

## 6. Committee Composition

### Appeals Committee

- One senior academic staff member (Chair)
- One learner support representative
- One academic member (not involved)
- Optional: Legal/HR advisor (non-voting)

### Conduct Committee

- One learner conduct officer (Chair)
- One academic staff member (not involved)
- One learner life or wellness representative
- Optional: Legal/HR advisor (non-voting)

**Note:** A quorum requires a minimum of three voting members.

## 7. Appeals Procedure

### 7.1. Submission:

- Must be submitted within **ten (10) business days** of the original decision.
- Grounds include: New material evidence, investigational errors, procedural errors, bias, or excessive sanctions.
- Submission Portal: <https://africainetwork.com/>

### 7.2. Initial Review:

- Acknowledgment within 3 days; Eligibility determination within 5 business days.

### 7.3. Hearing (if required):

- 5 business days' notice provided. Confidential setting (virtual/in-person).
- Learners may be accompanied by a support person.
- Proceedings may be recorded with consent.

### 7.4. Decision:

- Written outcome within **five (5) business days** of the decision. Includes reasons and next steps. Decisions are final.

#### **7.5. Remedies:**

- May uphold, amend, or overturn decisions; order new investigations; or recommend support services.

#### **7.6. Finality and Reconsideration:**

- Requests for reconsideration must be filed within **five (5) business days** of the outcome, strictly for new material evidence or significant procedural errors.

### **8. References**

- Registration and Selection Policy
- Assessment Policy and Procedure
- Community Guidelines (Onsite and Online)
- Learner Code of Conduct

**Contact:** support@africainetwork.com Legal notices must be submitted in writing to the official email address above.

**African AI Network (AAN) | Appeals/Conduct Committee Guidelines | Effective Date  
March 2026**